1. to bear true faith and allegiance to the Constitution of India,
2. to uphold the sovereignty and integrity of India,
3. to faithfully and conscientiously discharge the duties of his/her office, and
4. to do right to all manner of people in accordance with the Constitution and the law, without fear or favour, affection or ill will.

In his/her oath of secrecy, the Prime Minister swears that he/she will not directly or indirectly communicate or reveal to any person(s) any matter that is brought under his/her consideration or becomes known to him/her as a Union Minister except as may be required for the due discharge of his/her duties as such minister.

The term of the Prime Minister is not fixed and he/she holds office during the pleasure of the President. However, this does not mean that the President can dismiss the Prime Minister at any time. So long as the Prime Minister enjoys the majority support in the Lok Sabha, he/she cannot be dismissed by the President. However, if he/she loses the confidence of the Lok Sabha, he/she must resign or the President can dismiss him/her.[3]

The salary and allowances of the Prime Minister are determined by the Parliament from time to time[3a]. He/she gets the salary and allowances that are payable to a member of Parliament. Additionally, he/she gets a sumptuary allowance, free accommodation, travelling allowance, medical facilities, etc. In 2001, the Parliament increased the sumptuary allowance from ₹1,500 to ₹3,000 per month[3b].

POWERS AND FUNCTIONS OF THE PRIME MINISTER

The powers and functions of Prime Minister can be studied under the following heads:

 **In Relation to Council of Ministers**

The Prime Minister enjoys the following powers as head of the Union council of ministers:

1. He/she recommends persons who can be appointed as ministers by the President. The President can appoint only those persons as ministers who are recommended by the Prime Minister.
2. He/she allocates and reshuffles various portfolios among the ministers.
3. He/she can ask a minister to resign or advise the President to dismiss him/her in case of difference of opinion.
4. He/she presides over the meeting of council of ministers and influences its decisions.
5. He/she guides, directs, controls, and coordinates the activities of all the ministers.
6. He/she can bring about the collapse of the council of ministers by resigning from office.

Since the Prime Minister stands at the head of the council of ministers, the other ministers cannot function when the Prime Minister resigns or dies. In other words, the resignation or death of an incumbent Prime Minister automatically dissolves the council of ministers and thereby generates a